UTTARAKHAND
TRULY A DEVBHOOMI

Uttarakhand has always been known as the Abode of the Gods. Many of its holy places are well known to the devout, while some are waiting to be discovered by more pilgrims.

A holy land, which has drawn wise sages as well as devout pilgrims to its folds for thousands of years, Uttarakhand as a place exudes a rare spiritual energy. Home to exquisite hill-top temples, snow-wrapped shrines in remote settings, sacred rivers and divine lakes, Uttarakhand is a Devbhoomi like no other.

THESE ARE SOME OF THE HOLIEST SHRINES IN UTTARAKHAND:

KARTIKA SWAMI TEMPLE, RUDRAPRAYAG

The only abode of Lord Kartika Swami in Uttarakhand, and perhaps all of North India, the Kartika Swami Temple in Rudraprayag District has an ethereal location atop a hill and is a sight to behold.

Located near Kanak Chauri village on the Rudraprayag-Pokhari route, the temple is a mild uphill trek away. The walk from Kanak Chauri village, which is about three kilometres long, takes you to the stunning beauty of the Kartika Swami Temple. The invigorating walk is through dense forests marked with rhododendron trees taking pilgrims up to the ridge where the temple is located. The temple is dedicated to Lord Kartikeya, the elder son of Lord Shiva and Goddess Parvati.

According to myth, Lord Kartikeya offered his bones as a sign of devotion to his father. It is believed that this is the spot where the incident happened. The temple has a naturally carved idol of Kartika Swami in marble which shows the bones of Lord Kartikeya.

Situated on top of a mountain ridge, the temple offers divine views of the surrounding landscape. Some of the major peaks visible from here are Banderpunch, Kedarnath Dome, Chaukhamba Peak, Neelkanth Parvat, Dronagiri, Nanda Ghunti, Trishul, the Nanda Devi group of mountains as well as Meru and Sumeru Parvat.

The Kartika Swami Temple is 40 kilometres from Rudraprayag town. Major festivals celebrated at the temple are Kartika Poornima in November and an 11-day Kalash Yatra in June.

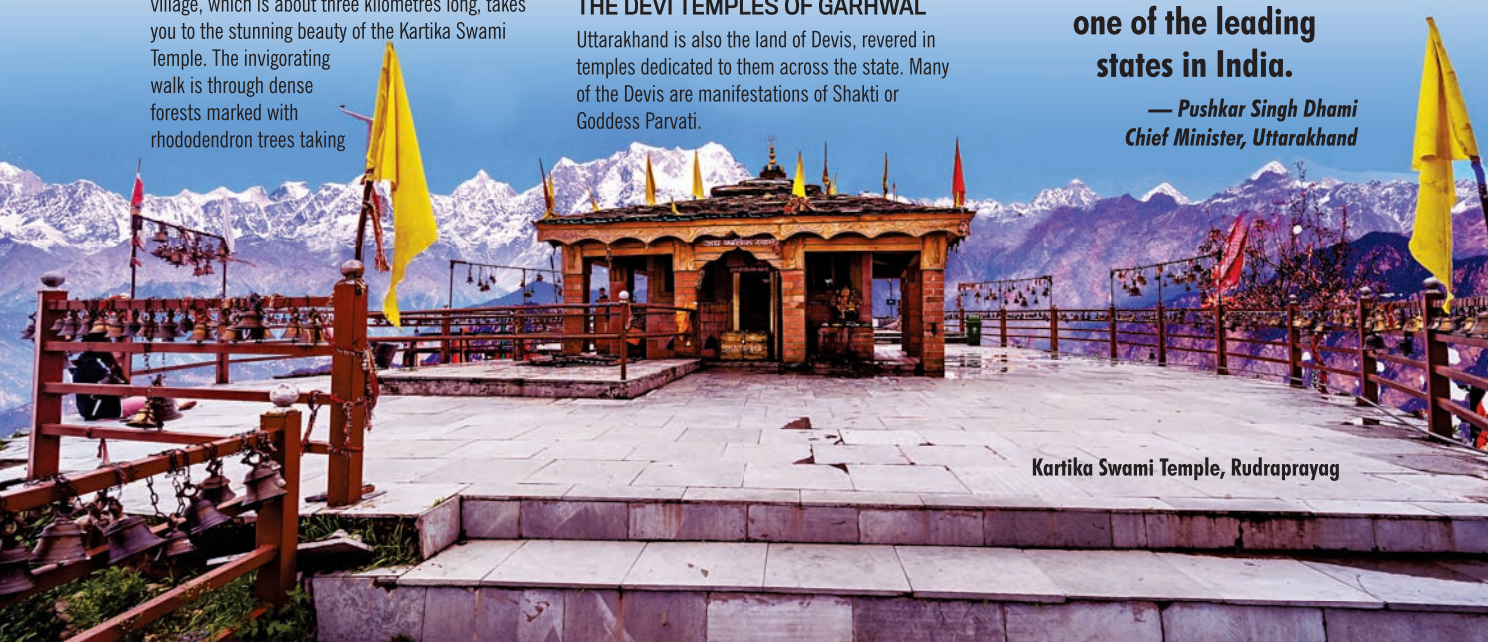
THE DEVI TEMPLES OF GARHWAL

Uttarakhand is also the land of Devis, revered in temples dedicated to them across the state. Many of the Devis are manifestations of Shakti or Goddess Parvati.



“The coming decade belongs to Uttarakhand itself. In the year 2025, when the state marks the silver jubilee of its establishment, we will celebrate that historic milestone by becoming one of the leading states in India.

— Pushkar Singh Dhami
Chief Minister, Uttarakhand



Kartika Swami Temple, Rudraprayag